Information for Students

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Duc A. Hoang

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A Brief Introduction
A Short CV

- **Name (in Vietnamese):** Hoàng Anh Đức
- **Name (in publications):** Duc A. Hoang
- **Current Position:** Lecturer at VNU-HUS, Hanoi, Vietnam (Feb. 2023 - present)
- **Research Interests:** Graph Algorithms, Combinatorial Reconfiguration
- **Education:**
  - **B.Math** degree from VNU-HUS, Hanoi, Vietnam (2008–2013)
  - **M.S.** and **Ph.D.** degrees (Information Science) from JAIST, Ishikawa, Japan (2013–2015 and 2015–2018 respectively)
- **Homepage:** https://hoanganhduc.github.io/ (contains everything about my research and teaching)

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Getting Scientific Papers/Books/etc.

A Brief Introduction
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If you want to work with me on some research problems:

- Please *skim through my recent publications* to have some ideas of what I have been working on
- Please *read this document*
- Please *send an email* to hoanganhduc@hus.edu.vn
- If we have not yet known each other, please *attach to your email a copy of your academic transcript* (an unofficial copy is fine)
- I expect you to at least have *some basic knowledge on discrete mathematics and graph theory* (which can be obtained by taking an undergraduate-level course)
  - Please take a look at *some recommended materials in this document*
  - Some other resources I collected can be found here

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Publishing in TCS

- **(Most Important Point)** Collaborate, work hard, and achieve your results
- **(Optional)** Maintain an e-print version on arXiv
- **(Optional)** Announce your results in some semiars, workshops, or unreferred conferences
- **(Recommended)** Submit your results to a referred conference
  - Some conferences are highly selective, for example, STOC, FOCS, SODA, ICALP, and so on
  - Quick notification (accept/reject) within around three to six months
  - Usually having just one round of review. Reviewers have no idea whether their comments have been addressed by the authors. (Some conferences have "rebuttal phase")
  - Reviewers are primarily focused on whether the work is important and superficially appears correct
- **(Recommended)** Submit your results to a referred journal
  - It is common to expand your conference's paper to a journal version. (Yes! You can publish both conference and journal versions of the same results)
  - Slow notification (accept/reject) within six months to a year
  - Your results will usually be reviewed thoroughly by 2-3 reviewers. Usually having more than one round of review
  - The journal version of your paper is the final version and can be trusted. (In several cases, flaws exist even in the journal version)

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Things You May (Not) Already Know

- Traditionally, in most areas of mathematics and theoretical computer science, authors are listed in alphabetical order by last name
- Academic Profiles: Google Scholar, ORCID
- Mailing Lists: DMANET, THEORYNT
- Journal Ranking:
  - Scimago Journal & Country Rank
  - Scopus Indexed Journals
  - WoS (Web of Science) Indexed Journals
- Conference Ranking:
  - CORE Rankings Portal
  - Conference Ranks
- List of TCS conferences and workshops @ StackExchange
- The Elsevier boyscott
- Uploading a paper to arXiv.org

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David Eppstein's Two Models of Algorithms Research

Two Models of Algorithms Research

I. Read lots of theory papers

II. Choose a problem with lots of previous work (evidence it's interesting)

III. (optional) Add extra complications to the problem so you can convince people your results are more difficult than previous work

III. Find an algorithm that's better than all the previous results

IV. Write it up and publish it in theory conferences and journals

I. Learn about areas outside of theoretical CS

II. Choose a problem in one of those application areas where faster or more accurate solutions can make a practical difference

III. Abstract essential features to get new clean theoretical problem

IV. Find an algorithm that's better than all the previous results

V. Write it up and publish it in theory conferences and journals

VI. Implement and communicate your results with the community your problem came from, discover related problems, repeat

Open problems in graph theory and geometry — D. Eppstein, ICS 269, 01/25/02

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Some Recommended Materials

Discrete Math

- Discrete Mathematics and Its Applications, 8th edition, by Kenneth H. Rosen
- Building Blocks for Theoretical Computer Science, by Margaret M. Fleck
- Lectures on Discrete Mathematics given by Shai Simonson at ArsDigita University in 2000
- Connecting Discrete Mathematics and Computer Science, by David Liben-Nowell. A preprint version of the book is available

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Some Recommended Materials

Algorithms, Computational Complexity

- Computers and Intractability: A Guide to the Theory of NP-Completeness, by Michael Garey and David S. Johnson – One of the most influential books on the NP-complete theory, which is usually known as "the Garey&Johnson book"
- Algorithms, by Jeff Erickson
- Computational Complexity: A Modern Approach, by Sanjeev Arora and Boaz Barak. A draft of the book is available
- Parameterized Algorithms by Marek Cygan, Fedor V. Fomin, Łukasz Kowalik, Daniel Lokshtanov, Dániel Marx, Marcin Pilipczuk, Michał Pilipczuk, and Saket Saurabhs

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Some Recommended Materials
Writing

- Paul R. Halmos's advice on How to write Mathematics. Download a PDF copy here
- Scientific Paper Writing: A Survival Guide, by Bodil Holst, illustrated by Jorge Cham of PhD Comics

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- Douglas B. West's Advice for students in Math 412
- Gary MacGillivray's Math Study Tips
- Mihir Bellare's The Ph.D Experience
- A Student's Guide to the Study, Practice, and Tools of Modern Mathematics, by Donald Bindner and Martin Erickson

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Getting Scientific Papers/Books/etc.

- **(For Vietnamese)** The Online Portal maintained by Vietnamese National Agency for Science and Technology Information
- If you cannot get a paper, **get in touch with the (corresponding) author(s) to ask for a copy before trying the following resources**
  - Mutual Aid-Science Community – you may get published papers by asking people in the community for help
  - Sci-Hub
  - Z-Library
    - Desktop App: Windows, MacOS, Linux (DEB)
  - Library Genesis: here or here
  - PDFDrive

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